

SENATE No. 2419

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Paul W. Mark

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to improve pedestrian safety.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>Paul W. Mark</i>	<i>Berkshire, Hampden, Franklin and Hampshire</i>	
<i>Thomas M. Stanley</i>	<i>9th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/24/2025</i>
<i>Jason M. Lewis</i>	<i>Fifth Middlesex</i>	<i>3/25/2025</i>
<i>Susannah M. Whipps</i>	<i>2nd Franklin</i>	<i>3/26/2025</i>
<i>Bruce E. Tarr</i>	<i>First Essex and Middlesex</i>	<i>4/3/2025</i>
<i>William J. Driscoll, Jr.</i>	<i>Norfolk, Plymouth and Bristol</i>	<i>4/18/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>6/12/2025</i>

SENATE No. 2419

By Mr. Mark, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 2419) of Paul W. Mark for legislation to update Massachusetts Department of Transportation manual for determining pedestrian clearance times at signalized crosswalks. Transportation.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to improve pedestrian safety.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Section 2 of Chapter 85 of the General Laws as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is
2 hereby amended by inserting in line 88 after the word “prohibited” the following line:-

3 “The department’s manual must indicate that where pedestrians who walk slower than
4 3.5 feet per second, or pedestrians who use wheelchairs, routinely use the crosswalk, a walking
5 speed of less than 3.5 feet per second should be considered in determining the pedestrian
6 clearance time. The department will be responsible for promulgating regulations that direct a
7 municipality to:

8 (a.) create a list of locations within their boundaries that are heavily used by pedestrians
9 who are likely to have: (i.) a walking speed lower than 3.5 feet per second as determined by
10 current research, (ii.) a slower than average walking speed due to a physical mobility issue, and
11 (iii.) slower walking speeds resulting from transporting, assisting, or conveying another person
12 through a signalized crosswalk.

13 (b.) require that locations contained in said list, where there are signalized crosswalks
14 regularly in use, account for the slower walking speed of pedestrians by adjusting signal walk
15 clearance times to a reasonable degree to allow for pedestrians to safely complete a crossing."